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Skullcandy Jib+

Balanced sound and budget-friendly, but not perfect

Skullcandy has carved a name for itself in the audio industry as a brand that caters to

people looking for affordable audio solutions. The company has overhauled its Jib Wireless earphones with their newest offering – the Skullcandy Jib+. Let's see whether the earphones stand up to our test.



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Price
₹2,499

fared quite well.

Connectivity is also pretty satisfactory. Skips and lags in audio tracks are rare since the earphones feature Bluetooth 5.0 and the wireless range, rated at 35 feet, seemed to hold up as well.

Unfortunately, the earphones displayed a below-average latency and the disparity between the audio and video was quite perceptible.

The earphones feature micro-USB charging, and a 6-hour battery life. The company claim held up quite well in our tests since we were able to extract round about 6 and a half hours worth of battery life from the earphones.

Last, but definitely not the least, Skullcandy claims that the Jib+ has Voice Assistant support. However, we found that there is no actual way to access the voice assistant on your smartphone directly from the Jib+. There is no dedicated button on the earphones to fire up your voice assistant, no button combination, no command, nothing. This is a major disappointment.

Performance

We were pleasantly surprised by the sound quality the Skullcandy Jib+ Wireless earphones boast, especially at this price point. The earphones have an uncommon amalgamation of boosted bass as well as treble. The latter, at times, does minutely overpower the bass though. In *War by Poets of the Fall*, you will notice that the bass guitar does seem a tad bit muted once the more treble-sounding instruments creep into the track. However, at no point does the sound become tinny or unpleasant, which is surprising. The bass, in

most cases, is deep, powerful and quite consistent, the mid-range and treble are balanced as well which translates well in genres such as rock, pop, and especially electronic. However, classical music, such as Beethoven's Symphony No. 5, isn't reproduced quite accurately.

Vocals are quite clear in tracks such as *Hello* by Adele, which are specifically crafted to let the vocals soar, however, in tracks such as *Pull Me Under* by Dream Theatre, they can suffer a tad bit due to the array of instruments present in the song, therefore layering and separation doesn't seem like something the Jib+ does elegantly. Highs appear to be sculpted in most tracks, however, we were able to pick up slight distortions while listening to *Fall Out Boy's Centuries* at 100 per cent volume. When we turned down the volume to 60 per cent, there was no distortion in the same track.

We found that the frequency response consistency is also decent, especially if the user arrives at the perfect fit and an air-tight seal. Unfortunately, the soundstage on the Jib+ leaves something to be desired.

Performance-wise, the Jib+ does tick many boxes of a good pair of budget wireless earphones. Unfortunately, we found that the call quality is sorely lacking on these earphones.

Bottomline

The Skullcandy Jib+ Wireless earphones are quite a decent buy at ₹1,990. You get balanced mids and highs, as well as good bass push. Looks-wise, Skullcandy has kept it clean and minimalistic, except for the bulky modules. The absence of the advertised voice assistant feature is disappointing. However, if you are able to get past this, then you have a good pair of wireless earphones that give users access to a balanced sound profile and decent battery life for under ₹2,000.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

IMPEDANCE: 16 Ohms + 15% | DRIVER: 9mm | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20Hz - 20KHz | SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL: 95±3dB | WIRELESS CONNECTION: Bluetooth 5.0 | MICROPHONE: Yes | BATTERY LIFE: 6 Hours | WEIGHT: 17g

CONTACT

SKULLCANDY | PHONE: 1860-500-3858 | EMAIL: help-in@skullcandy.com | WEBSITE: www.skullcandy.in

Build and design

The Skullcandy Jib+ retains the ultra-thin TPE audio cables as connectors to earbuds, but the portion between the two pill-shaped modules is reinforced by flat TPE cables which seem more sturdy.

There are two bulky modules present on the earphones. The left-side module houses three circular buttons – the pause/play button, the left button increases the volume or skips tracks while the right one does the opposite. There's also an LED light which blinks every time the earphones are turned on/off and when they are in pairing mode. Additionally, there's also a micro-USB port tucked under the hood of a rubberised flap. The flap is present since the earphones are splash resistant.

The other module on the right side is an added weight to stabilise the earphones around your neck. Overall, we wish the modules were more compact.

The earbuds present on the Skullcandy Jib+ are quite standard-looking. The company has included three sizes of ear tips – S, M and L as well as a pair of stability gels for additional comfort and security.

Once you figure out the perfect fit for you, the earphones are decently stable in-ear.

Features

We tested out the Skullcandy Jib+ for its splash resistance feature and it